

COMPLETE CHESS LEARNING LIBRARY

The Complete Bishop's Opening

Flexible development, transpositions, central breaks, and attacking setups

TRAINING WORKBOOK

30 focused chapters - model positions - decision rules - retrieval practice

Designed to change what you notice, calculate, remember, and do at the board.

Workbook Method

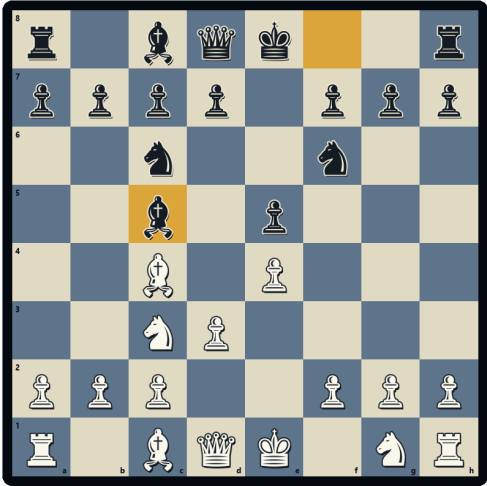
Attempt each page before reopening the matching course-book chapter. Speak answers aloud or write them. The self-score rewards a clear decision rule and the opponent's best reply, not a lucky move guess.

REVIEW THRESHOLD

8-10: review in one week. 5-7: review tomorrow. 0-4: reread the course chapter now, then retry from a blank board.

Use the workbook again after a game reaches a related structure. Real-game retrieval is the final test.

01. Classical Nc6 Setup



02 - Quiet Bishop's Opening

POSITION PROMPT

Both sides develop naturally while White keeps the g1-knight and f-pawn flexible.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nc6 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nc3 Bc5

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

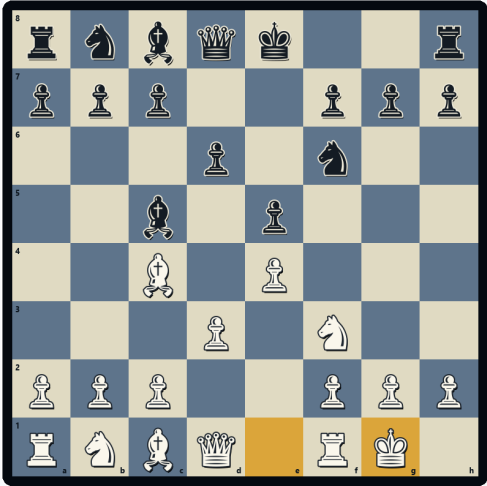
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

02. Berlin Defense Quiet Line



02 - Quiet Bishop's Opening

POSITION PROMPT

Black attacks e4 immediately and White supports it with a compact d3 center.

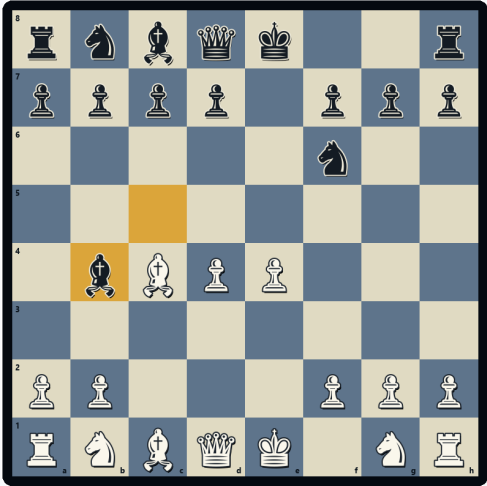
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nf6 3. d3 Bc5 4. Nf3 d6 5. O-O

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
-
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
-
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
-
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
-
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
-

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

03. Boi Variation



02 - Quiet Bishop's Opening

POSITION PROMPT

Both bishops point toward the center and White prepares c3-d4 in one move.

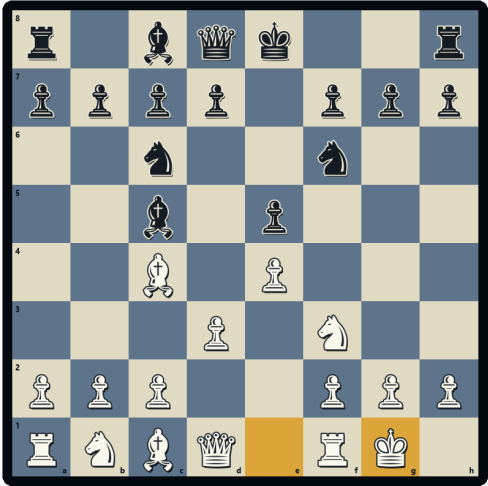
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Bc5 3. c3 Nf6 4. d4 exd4 5. cxd4 Bb4+

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
-
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
-
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
-
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
-
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
-

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THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

04. Italian Game Transposition



03 - Italian and Vienna Transpositions

POSITION PROMPT

White's move order becomes a quiet Italian once Nf3 and ...Nc6 appear.

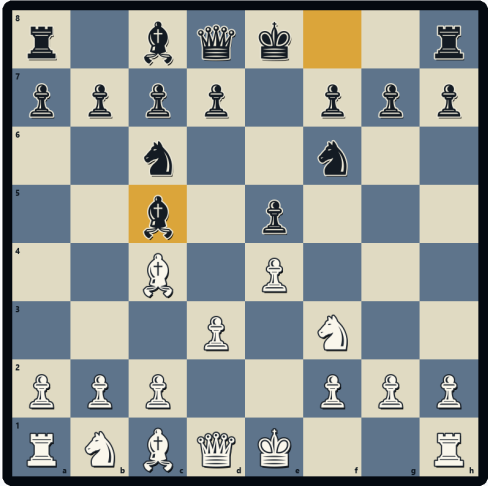
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nc6 3. Nf3 Bc5 4. d3 Nf6 5. O-O

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
-
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
-
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
-
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
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5. What ending would favor you, and why?
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CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

05. Four Knights Transposition



03 - Italian and Vienna Transpositions

POSITION PROMPT

Both knights develop and the position enters an Italian Four Knights structure.

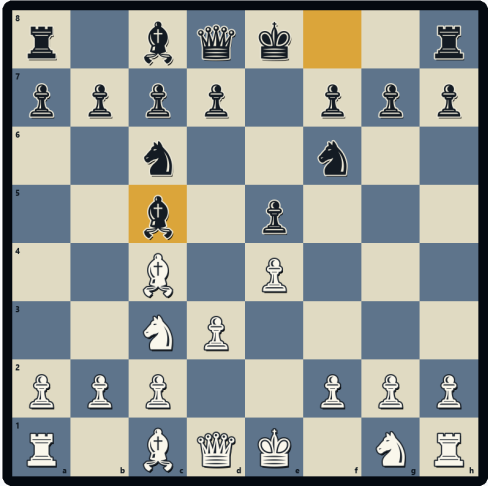
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nf6 3. d3 Nc6 4. Nf3 Bc5

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
-
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
-
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
-
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
-
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
-

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THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

06. Vienna Hybrid



03 - Italian and Vienna Transpositions

POSITION PROMPT

White develops the queen knight first and keeps the g1-knight flexible for f3 or e2.

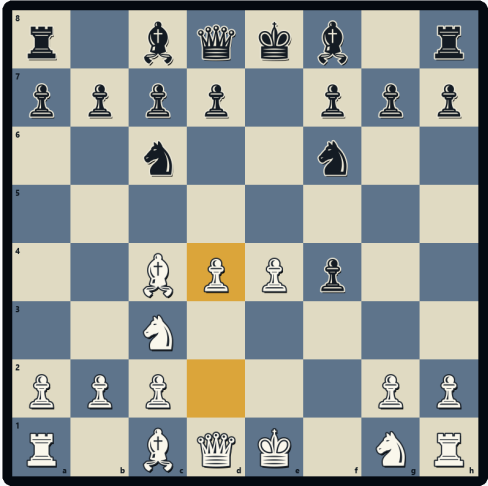
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nf6 3. Nc3 Nc6 4. d3 Bc5

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
-
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
-
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
-
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
-
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
-

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CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

07. Vienna Gambit Transition



03 - Italian and Vienna Transpositions

POSITION PROMPT

White uses the Bishop's move order to reach a Vienna Gambit with the bishop already aimed at f7.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nf6 3. Nc3 Nc6 4. f4 exf4 5. d4

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

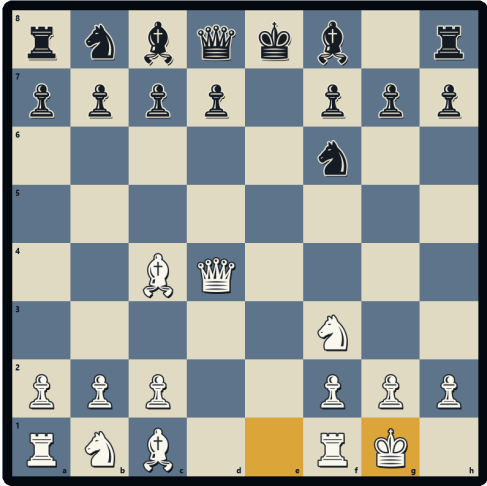
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

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THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

08. Urusov Gambit



04 - White Gambits

POSITION PROMPT

White offers central material to gain development and open lines against the king.

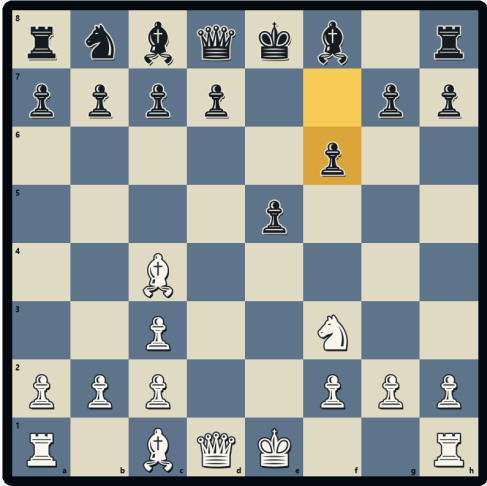
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nf6 3. d4 exd4 4. Nf3 Nxe4 5. Qxd4 Nf6 6. O-O

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
-
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
-
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
-
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
-
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
-

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THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

09. Boden-Kieseritzky Gambit



04 - White Gambits

POSITION PROMPT

White accepts doubled c-pawns to open lines and accelerate development after Black takes e4.

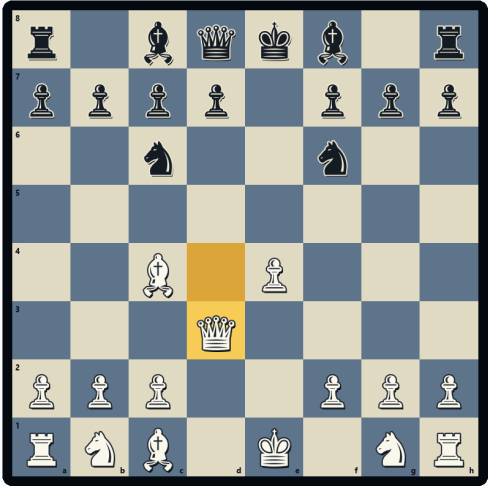
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nf6 3. Nf3 Nxe4 4. Nc3 Nxc3 5. dxc3 f6

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
-
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
-
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
-
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
-
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
-

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THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

10. Ponziani Center Gambit



04 - White Gambits

POSITION PROMPT

White recaptures with the queen to keep a central pawn but risks losing development tempi.

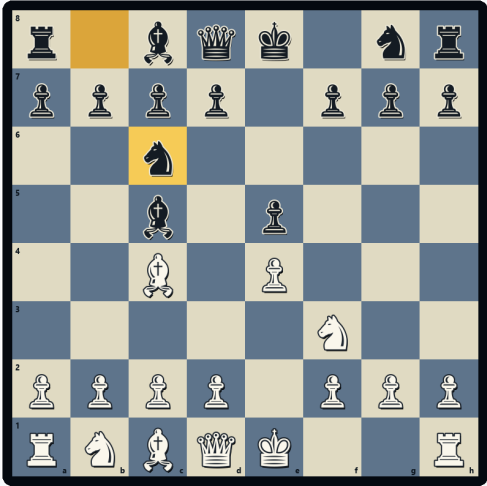
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nf6 3. d4 exd4 4. Qxd4 Nc6 5. Qd3

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
-
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
-
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
-
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
-
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
-

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THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

11. Lewis Gambit Decision Point



04 - White Gambits

POSITION PROMPT

White reaches the decision whether to offer d4 for rapid development or transpose to a normal Italian setup.

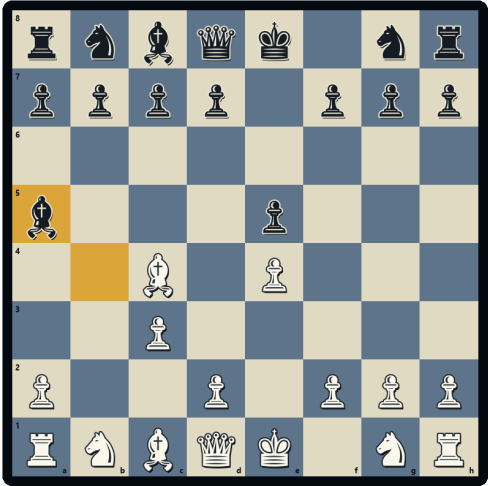
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Bc5 3. Nf3 Nc6

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
-
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
-
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
-
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
-
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
-

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
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STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

12. Wing Gambit



04 - White Gambits

POSITION PROMPT

White offers the b-pawn to gain c3 and d4 with tempo against the bishop.

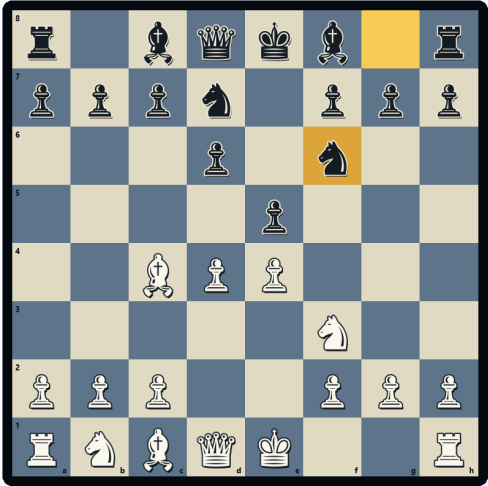
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Bc5 3. b4 Bxb4 4. c3 Ba5

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
-
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
-
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
-
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
-
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
-

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

13. Philidor Setup



02 - Quiet Bishop's Opening

POSITION PROMPT

Black protects e5 with a compact Philidor shell and delays active development.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 d6 3. d4 Nd7 4. Nf3 Ngf6

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

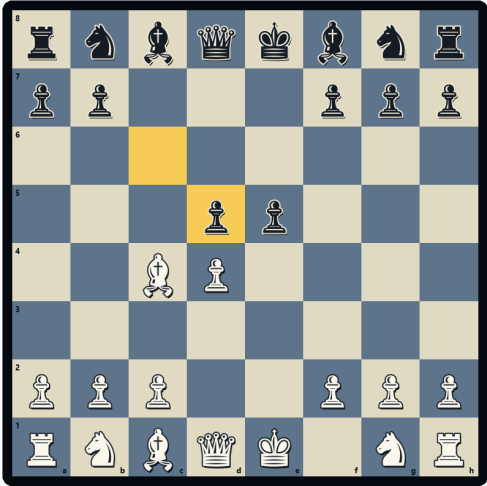
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

4. Which piece has the least useful job?

5. What ending would favor you, and why?

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THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

14. Philidor Counterattack ...c6



05 - Black Countergambits

POSITION PROMPT

Black prepares an immediate ...d5 challenge and asks White to clarify the bishop and center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 c6 3. d4 d5 4. exd5 cxd5

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

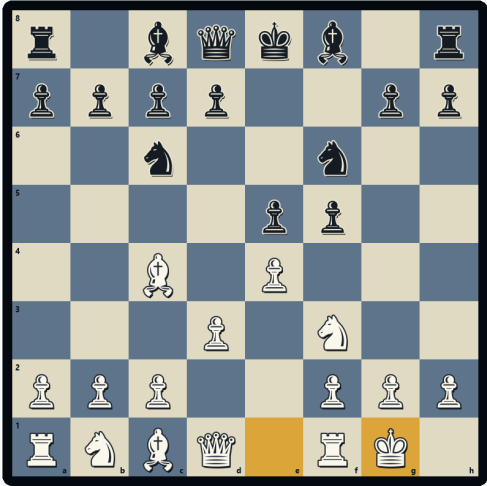
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

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CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

15. Calabrese Countergambit



05 - Black Countergambits

POSITION PROMPT

Black attacks e4 immediately with the f-pawn and accepts weakened king squares.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 f5 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nf3 Nc6 5. O-O

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

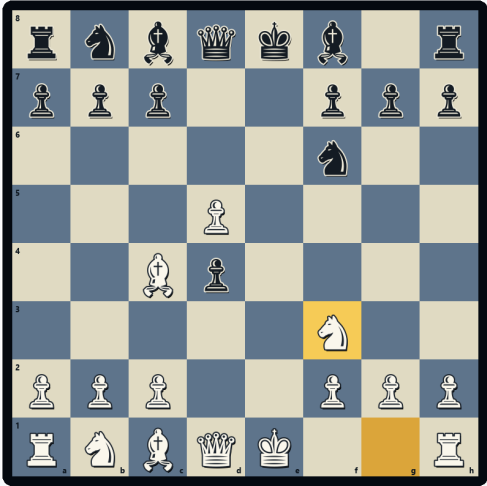
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

4. Which piece has the least useful job?

5. What ending would favor you, and why?

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THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

16. Khan Gambit ...d5



05 - Black Countergambits

POSITION PROMPT

Black challenges the bishop and center immediately, offering rapid development for a pawn.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 d5 3. exd5 Nf6 4. d4 exd4 5. Nf3

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

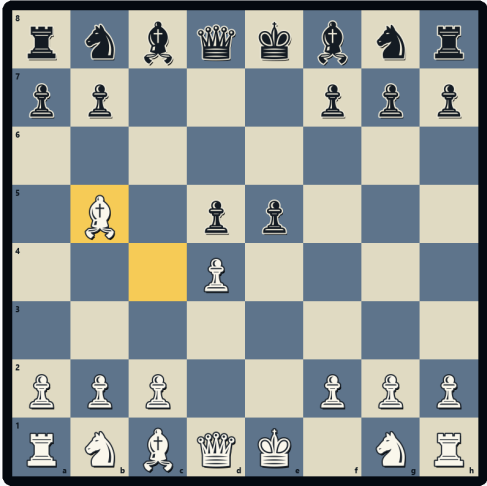
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

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THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

17. Early ...c6 and ...d5



05 - Black Countergambits

POSITION PROMPT

Black builds a direct central challenge and may gain space against the bishop.

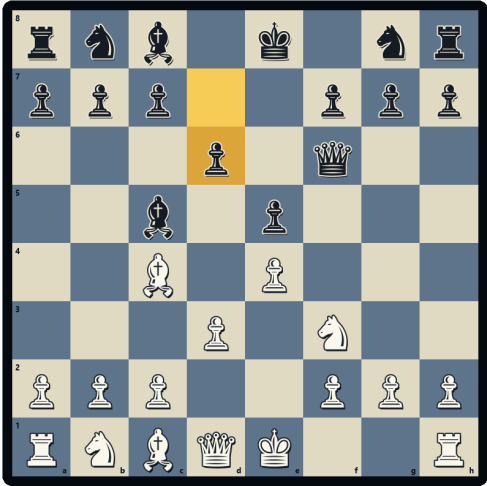
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 c6 3. d4 d5 4. exd5 cxd5 5. Bb5+

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
-
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
-
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
-
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
-
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
-

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

18. Early ...Qf6



06 - Early Black Sidelines

POSITION PROMPT

Black defends e5 and creates primitive pressure on f2 with the queen and bishop.

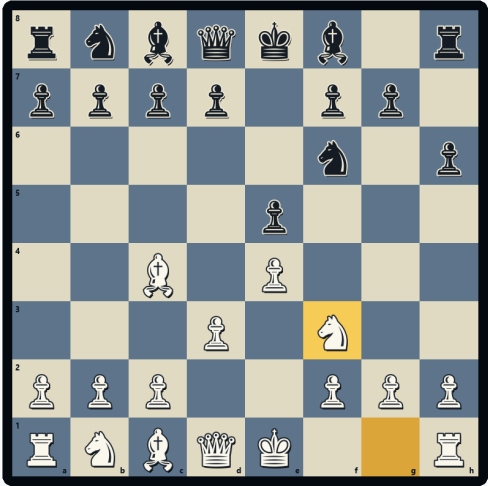
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Qf6 3. d3 Bc5 4. Nf3 d6

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
-
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
-
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
-
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
-
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
-

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

19. Early ...h6



06 - Early Black Sidelines

POSITION PROMPT

Black spends a tempo preventing Bg5 without challenging the center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 h6 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nf3

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

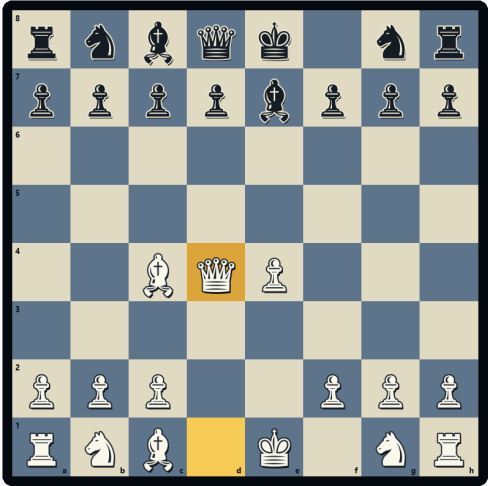
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

4. Which piece has the least useful job?

5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

20. Early ...Be7



06 - Early Black Sidelines

POSITION PROMPT

Black chooses a modest bishop square and invites White to occupy the center.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Be7 3. d4 exd4 4. Qxd4

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

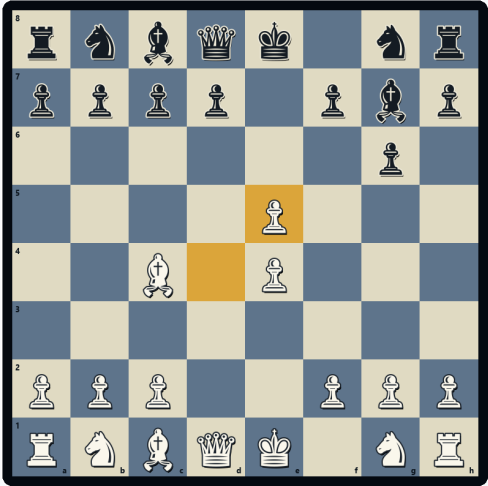
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

4. Which piece has the least useful job?

5. What ending would favor you, and why?

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THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

21. Early ...g6



06 - Early Black Sidelines

POSITION PROMPT

Black fianchettoes but delays pressure on e4 and central development.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 g6 3. d4 Bg7 4. dxe5

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

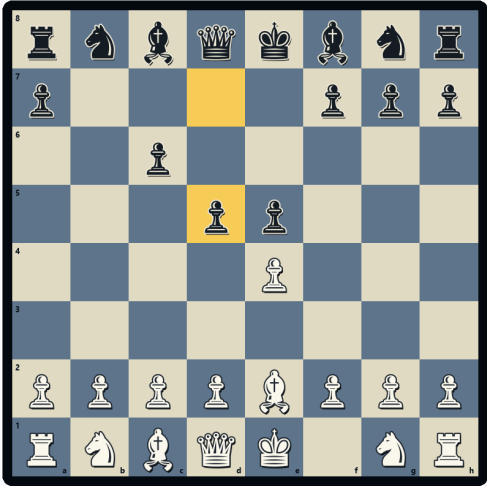
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

4. Which piece has the least useful job?

5. What ending would favor you, and why?

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THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

22. Early ...b5



06 - Early Black Sidelines

POSITION PROMPT

Black offers a queenside pawn to gain tempi against the bishop and build a broad center.

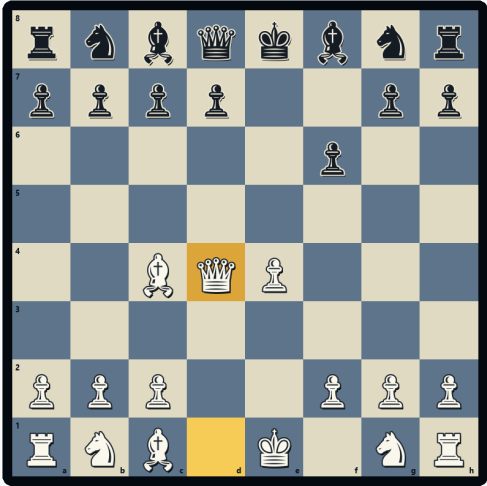
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 b5 3. Bxb5 c6 4. Be2 d5

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
-
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
-
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
-
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
-
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
-

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

23. Early ...f6



06 - Early Black Sidelines

POSITION PROMPT

Black overprotects e5 but weakens the king and blocks the g8-knight.

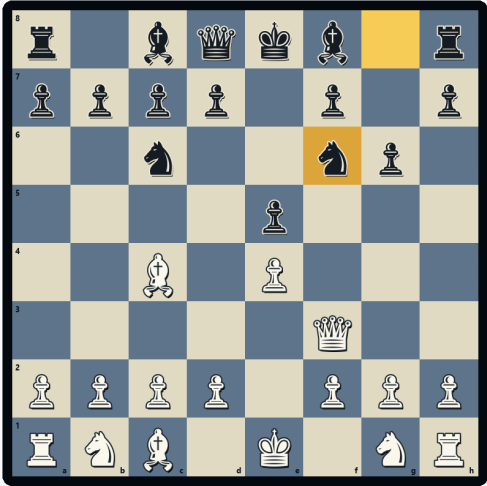
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 f6 3. d4 exd4 4. Qxd4

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
-
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
-
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
-
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
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5. What ending would favor you, and why?
-

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

24. Early Qh5 Pressure



07 - Active White Systems

POSITION PROMPT

White creates an immediate f7 threat but commits the queen before development.

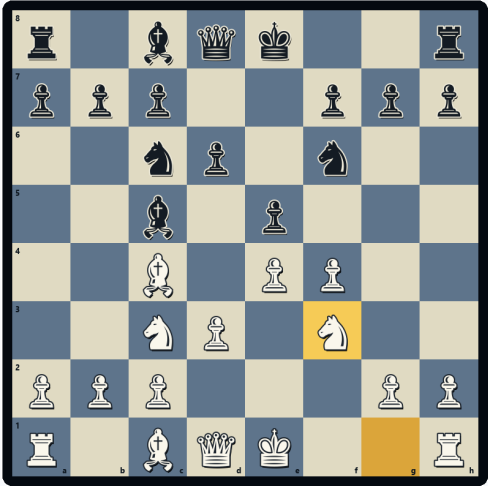
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nc6 3. Qh5 g6 4. Qf3 Nf6

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
-
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
-
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
-
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
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-

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
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CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

25. Kingside f4 Plan



07 - Active White Systems

POSITION PROMPT

White develops first and only then uses a Vienna-style kingside expansion.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nc6 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nc3 Bc5 5. f4 d6 6. Nf3

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

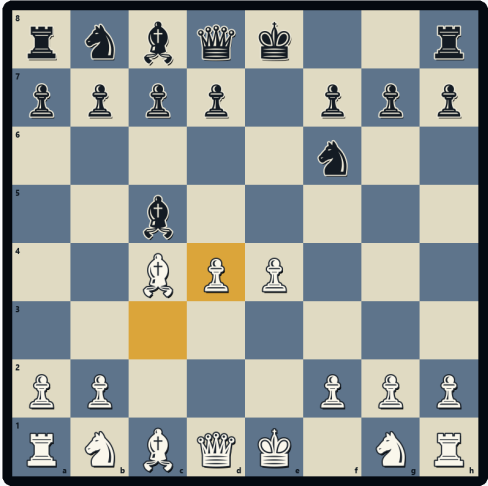
- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

26. Classical c3-d4 Center



07 - Active White Systems

POSITION PROMPT

White builds a broad center and gains time against the c5-bishop.

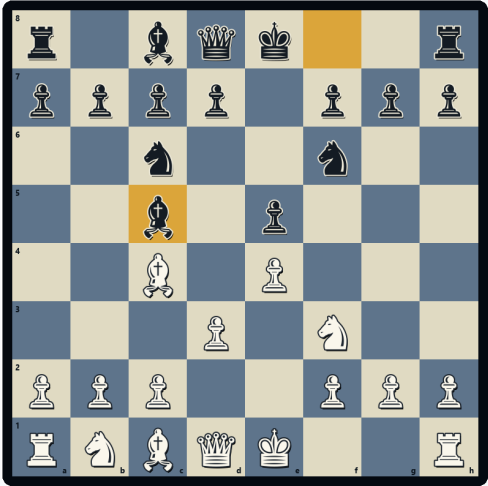
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Bc5 3. c3 Nf6 4. d4 exd4 5. cxd4

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
-
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
-
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
-
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
-
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
-

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

27. Nf3 Direct Transposition



03 - Italian and Vienna Transpositions

POSITION PROMPT

White immediately commits to Nf3 and enters an Italian structure.

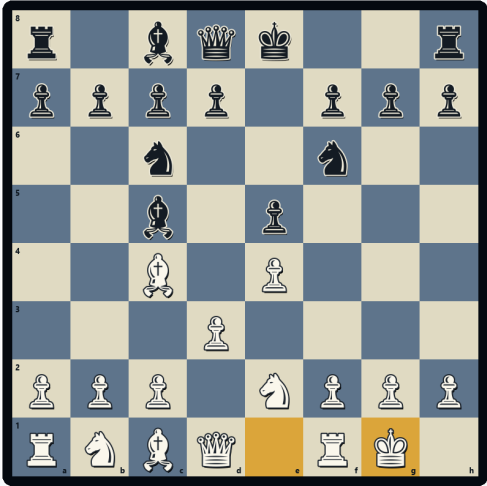
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nf6 3. Nf3 Nc6 4. d3 Bc5

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
-
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
-
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
-
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
-
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
-

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

28. Ne2 Flexible Setup



02 - Quiet Bishop's Opening

POSITION PROMPT

White develops the knight to e2, keeping the f-pawn free and avoiding blocks on c3.

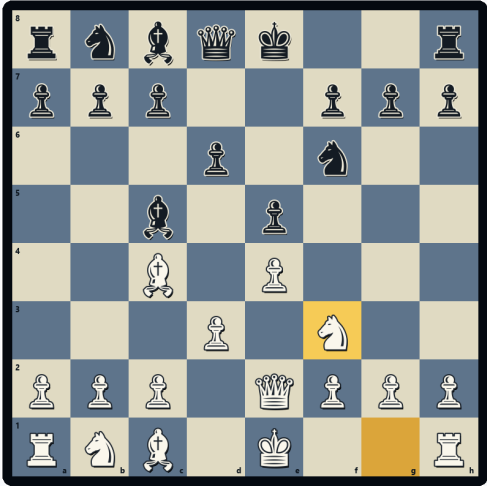
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nc6 3. d3 Nf6 4. Ne2 Bc5 5. O-O

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
-
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
-
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
-
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
-
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
-

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

29. Qe2 Support System



02 - Quiet Bishop's Opening

POSITION PROMPT

White supports e4 with the queen and keeps the f-pawn and knight routes flexible.

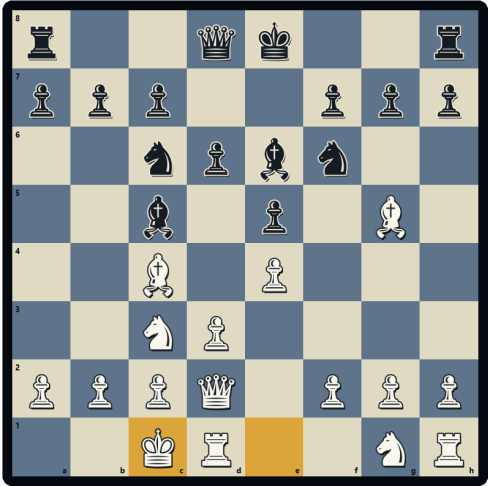
REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nf6 3. d3 Bc5 4. Qe2 d6 5. Nf3

1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?
-
2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.
-
3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?
-
4. Which piece has the least useful job?
-
5. What ending would favor you, and why?
-

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

30. Opposite-Castling System



08 - Structures and Repertoire Choices

POSITION PROMPT

White clears the queenside and castles long to create a sharper attacking game.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nc6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. d3 Bc5 5. Bg5 d6 6. Qd2 Be6 7. O-O-O

- 1. What does the opponent threaten or improve next?

- 2. Name two serious candidates and the best reply to each.

- 3. Which pawn break or exchange changes the structure?

- 4. Which piece has the least useful job?

- 5. What ending would favor you, and why?

SELF-SCORE	0 = guessed 1 = partial 2 = clear rule and best reply
THREAT	__ / 2
CANDIDATES	__ / 2
STRUCTURE	__ / 2
PIECE JOB	__ / 2
FORECAST	__ / 2

Monthly Retention Audit

Select ten random chapters and complete them under a ten-minute total limit. Track the categories you repeatedly miss: threat, candidate, structure, piece job, or forecast.

Do not restart the entire course. Return to the smallest group of chapters that repairs the repeated error, then test again in one week.